

Should You Get A Blu-ray or A Regular DVD Player?

With their prices expected to fall under Rs 20,000 and availability of compatible titles, Blu-ray players—the next big thing in playback—are set to take the market by storm. Can you afford to ignore them?



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DVD players play disks that are produced according to DVD-Video and DVD-Audio technical standards. These come in a variety of form factors with a number of features. In the market, you would find standard DVD play-

ers, DVD players with recorder, portable DVD players and the latest DVD players incorporating Blu-ray technology. The differences between them are based on how you plan to use the player and the viewing quality you want.

So before you buy a DVD player for yourself, it's important to understand the various types.

What's available?

Standard DVD players. Standard DVD players are the most common. These are typically 40x5x25 cm³ in size. They operate on your household mains power and are meant to be connected to a television. The body of the player is primarily metallic, while the front panel is plastic. Of course, there are some models marketed as 'second-room' DVD players that are smaller in size and made entirely of plastic.

Standard DVD players can play DVDs, audio CDs, MP3 and video CDs. A few include a home cinema decoder (Dolby Digital and Digital Theater System (DTS)) and play videos in the MPEG-4 video compression format (such as DivX) that is popular on the Internet.

You can get a standard DVD player for Rs 2500 to Rs 5000.

Portable DVD players. Most portable DVD players have an attached LCD screen with built-in stereo speakers and are usually powered by lithium-ion batteries. These are made to withstand slight shocks that can affect the disk play and are apt for long road trips.

Typically, portable DVD players come with a charger and have a small screen size of 17.8 to 25.4 cm (7 to 10 inches). The battery usually lasts 2.5 to 3.5 hours. Some of the portable DVD players come with additional connectivity so that these can be hooked up to a television. This allows them to be used as a regular DVD player when at home.